

US Bank - Sarah Overview

Speaker 1: All right.

Speaker 2: Okay, so US Bank came to Sam with this problem. They have these things called freight payments, and it's literally how large companies—think of Nike, um—get their goods places by, by US Bank basically fronts the money for the carrier. And so once that shipment actually gets there, US Bank is immediately delivering that money to that carrier.

Speaker 2: The reason that is important and the visibility into that is, like, if the carrier is getting paid immediately, it starts to cut down costs because they give better deals to the business, understanding that they're getting paid in an efficient manner. And so US Bank has a ton of—so basically one of these large clients who US Bank went tell was said, "If you don't put AI in your product, we're not going to use you."

Speaker 2: And they said, "Well, what—what does our product not have that you're missing?" And they didn't have an answer.

Speaker 2: They just said, "We need AI." I know.

Speaker 2: So, um, so basically US Bank did a bunch of brainstorming and they were thinking through this, and the thing that they came up with is they have a ton of data about all of this stuff. They're showing a minimal amount of it to their customers in an authenticating experience.

Speaker 2: And so a lot of these people aren't, like, statisticians. Um, and so they want to be able to have, like, a very normal layman's terms AI chat that helps them understand and comprehend, like, the data and the statistics available to them and be actionable upon those.

Speaker 2: So not only just providing them, like, general information, but also, like, helping them, um, modify that. So maybe, like, while they're chatting, the charts are kind of modifying and helping—helping them kind of understand the future things.

Speaker 1: Oh, that's cool.

Speaker 2: Yeah. Some of the questions they said, um, like, ways to save money across carriers are things being delivered on time between carriers. Is one carrier outperforming others?

Speaker 2: Are there—like, what's impacting my shipment rate and timing? Things like that.

Speaker 2: Um, and then, you know, "We offer free shipping on items over \$100. How much is this costing us?"

Speaker 2: So really helping them—informing them on their, like, whole carrier business. Um, and so the other thing is they said something about reconciling invoices between payments.

Speaker 2: I'm going to leave it to you to research what that means. Um, but they—some other basic, like, account functionality, right, that gives them full visibility into this, like.

Speaker 1: Like, multiple things that have been happening.

Speaker 2: Yes. Yeah. So between the.

Speaker 1: Historicals.

Speaker 2: Yeah. Um, so, so that's kind of what they're looking for. And US Bank, basically this large client, came to them and said, "If we don't see a roadmap of your AI implementation on this tool and what you're going to—like, how you're going to enhance it, we're going to go somewhere else."

Speaker 1: Oh.

Speaker 2: And so the other thing I just added into the brief was just, like, not only, like, what's this, like, MVP thing look like, but how does it get enhanced and rolled out over, like, the course of a year? So.

Speaker 1: I love that.

Speaker 2: Is that enough information?

Speaker 1: It's plenty.

Speaker 2: Any questions? I mean, that's—that's kind of what they—what I got.

Speaker 1: Um, maybe just to, like, reframe the offering space. Um, do you—how much—like, how much of it is focused on managing the payments versus managing the activity of the freight?

Speaker 2: US Bank is—it's—it's the activity. I think it's more the visibility of the payments versus managing them.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 2: Because US Bank is giving them that, like, loan upfront to make sure everything is, like, going through.

Speaker 1: And do they—do they mention any, like, top carriers for them? Like, is it, like.

Speaker 2: I think it's like FedEx and.

Speaker 1: FedEx, okay.

Speaker 2: Yeah. UPS and things like that.

Speaker 1: Gotcha.

Speaker 2: So that's why they're—I just—I had no idea this was even a thing. You know, you need to be having some money for carriers. Um, but this is actually, like, a huge cost for some of those large clients.

Speaker 2: So that's why.

Speaker 1: Yeah.

Speaker 2: It's important. Like, the more efficient US Bank can be with its payments and, like, providing this information, um, the more customers will stick with them.

Speaker 3: Does the company end up paying US Bank back? Is that part of this project too?

Speaker 2: Um, like, if US Bank is fronting the money.

Speaker 3: Yeah. Is the company giving them the money to front that, or does the company owe them the money once the freight gets there?

Speaker 2: I am not sure. But I also in the brief included Lauren Woods. Have you met her?

Speaker 2: She's new. Um, she said she will be available for questions.

Speaker 2: So for the duration of this, if you want to write to her and ask questions, um, she will be answering you.

Speaker 1: Cool.

Speaker 2: So accessibility to her. And she knows way more than I. Um, Lauren—Lauren Woods—and I'll include the other name that I just met yesterday, Justin Higgins.

Speaker 3: Yeah.

Speaker 2: So, um, with data. So I thought—K, I thought this would be a fun data plus.

Speaker 3: Data is written on my forehead.

Speaker 2: I know. I know.

Speaker 3: I can wait for it.

Speaker 2: I can't wait. But in the—in the file that I provided for you, there's, um, so this is actually, like, a real thing that she also wants to provide a, like, staffing plan to.

Speaker 3: Oh, yeah.

Speaker 2: And so they asked for a data strategist and data analyst for this, and she wants to go over—or go back and say, like, "Why don't you get CX, data, and a field person on this as, like, a small pod?"

Speaker 3: Yeah.

Speaker 2: And, like, see what we can do. And then if this is something that's going to feel relevant, she'll bring that with it.

Speaker 3: Okay.

Speaker 2: Um, and so what—so there's my brief in there that I did. And then, um, the second Word document is basically, like, what she put together about that. She called it a staff opportunity, but this is kind of, like, how to be strategically thinking about staffing that.

Speaker 2: And then the last one is her account planning documentation.

Speaker 1: Sweet.

Speaker 2: For US Bank because she's trying to, like, really grow it because it's one of the top 100 companies. So.

Speaker 3: And Sylva?

Speaker 2: US Bank. Are you switching teams?

Speaker 3: I thought I was here. No? Okay.

Speaker 1: That, that, that folder, is that, um, did you link that somewhere?

Speaker 2: Oh, sorry, Tom. You're not on our—I sent it to our CX chat.

Speaker 1: I was like, I'm—I'm pretty sure I'm getting left out of something.

Speaker 2: You were.

Speaker 1: Uh, okay. I'm going to stop our transcript. That was very helpful.